

us. The major impact is seeing more female cricketers on the field who want to play for the country. We see it in clubs, where there are a lot of admissions coming in for women athletes.

Deepti Sharma and yourself are off-spin bowling all-rounders. When there are two experienced players of the same profile vying for a spot in the team, is there a rivalry? What are the conversations like between you both?

Deepti and I debuted in 2014, and



(Left to right) India women's bowling coach Aavishkar Salvi, along with Sneh Rana and Deepti Sharma, accept the National Team of the Year award from Shubhangi Kulkarni, Nilima Joglekar, and Parveen Chander Kumar (SVP, Taj Group) at the Sportstar Aces Awards 2026. EMMANUAL YOGINI



we have been playing together since then. It feels really good when I share the field with her. A lot of people don't know this, but we talk a lot in between overs, because we tend to share the ball. We make a strategy of what is going on at one end, what you will use at the other end, so that it benefits the team. There should always be a sweet rivalry so that you don't take your place for granted.

There are a lot of spinners in the current Indian set-up, many of them young and with years ahead of them. How do you constantly evolve your game, especially in the T20 format, to compete?

If I talk about myself, I have learned a lot of variations. My idol, R. Ashwin, who's a master of spin, told me to just be confident and have belief in myself.

We keep learning in the nets. 'If I bowl like this, or with a grip like this, what will happen?' We enjoy the process. With our bowling coach, Aavishkar (Salvi) sir, we keep talking and experimenting. I think this is the way to evolve. You find a new way by yourself, a way to express yourself.

[On batting] I've been working on it for years now. I give myself a scenario — 'you have to make 10 runs in 4 balls, or 15 runs in 4 balls. How will you approach batting? What should your mindset be at that time?' When you put yourself in a difficult situation like that in the nets, it reflects during the match.

With the T20 World Cup just months away, what areas does India need to improve in? Bowling has been an area of concern at times. Do you think so too?

I would not say particularly bowling, but with the kind of pitches being prepared, it's difficult to bowl. But we are working on that. We make strategies. We talk to coaches. What if the situation arises where you have to defend a run off the last ball? So, we give ourselves that scenario. Looking forward, we will apply whatever we are working on in the South Africa series.